

CSC 281

Fibonacci Using Recursion and Iteration

Objective

In this assignment, you will implement the Fibonacci sequence in two different ways:

1. Recursive implementation
2. Iterative implementation using a loop

The goal is to compare performance and understand when to use each approach. All implementations must be written in Java.

Reminder: Fibonacci Definition

$$\text{fib}(n) = \text{fib}(n-1) + \text{fib}(n-2)$$

Base cases: $\text{fib}(0)=0$, $\text{fib}(1)=1$

Part 1: Implement Fibonacci in Two Ways

- A. Recursive version
- B. Iterative version

Note:

- You must write both the recursive and iterative versions in Java.
- Use standard Java libraries only.
- Do not use built-in functions or external libraries that compute Fibonacci for you.

Part 2: Compute Fibonacci Values

Test at least: $n = 5, 10, 15, 20, 25, 30, 35, 40$

Also attempt $\text{fib}(100)$ using both methods.

Part 3: Measure Running Time

Record running time for each method and value of n .

Include a table with:

- n
- Recursive result
- Recursive time
- Iterative result
- Iterative time

Part 4: Create a Line Chart

Create a chart with:

- x-axis: n
- y-axis: running time
- one line for recursion
- one line for iteration

Part 5: Answer Questions

- Did both implementations produce the same results?
- Which implementation was faster? Why?
- How did recursive time change as n increased?
- How did iterative time change as n increased?
- Could you compute fib(100) recursively?
- Which implementation is better for large n and why?
- What repeated work occurs?

Submission Requirements

1. Source code
2. Report (with table, chart, answers)
3. Screenshot of program output